

Parent Guide — senior / module-03- ayurveda-good-health

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Module 3 (Senior): Ayurveda

Your student's age: Senior (Grades 9–12) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min

What your student is learning

A serious comparative-medicine module:

- Ayurveda's place within IKS — Upaveda of the Atharva Veda, 8 branches (*aṣṭāṅga*), 3 foundational texts (Caraka, Suśruta, Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya).
- **Primary-source reading** — Caraka Saṃhitā in IAST + translation.
- **Tridosha theory in depth** — classical exposition + contemporary scholarly engagement.
- **Modern evidence base** — what survives RCT scrutiny (turmeric anti-inflammatory, dinacharya / circadian biology, yoga / HRV), what doesn't (dosha typology as strict biomarker classification).
- **The integration debate** — AYUSH ministry, AIIMS integration units, NHS pilots, professional medical body positions.
- **A 5–6 page research-synthesis paper** integrating classical primary, modern empirical, and historical/scholarly sources.

The honest framing

- Ayurveda is a sophisticated, real framework with substantial evidence base for parts of it.
- It is NOT a substitute for modern medicine where modern medicine works (infections, emergencies, surgery, mental health crises).
- The “either-or” framing is false. The “both-and” framing requires honest discrimination between well-evidenced and weakly-evidenced claims.

Important safety note

Nothing in this module is medical advice. If your student is on any medication or treatment, that continues unchanged. If they propose stopping treatment because of this module, intervene.

How to help

Helpful: - Discuss family Ayurvedic traditions honestly — what works, what’s habit, what’s untested. - For the paper: be a thoughtful skeptic. “Where’s the evidence?” is the key question. - If you’re in healthcare yourself, share your professional experience honestly.

Not helpful: - Push them toward “Ayurveda is all true” or “Ayurveda is all false.” Neither serves. - Discourage engagement with the integration debate. It’s politically loaded; learning to engage politically loaded scholarly questions is a real skill.

Assessment

- Summative quiz: 35
- Paper: 65
- Total: 100

What success looks like

- Your student can read a Caraka Saṃhitā verse in IAST with translation.
- They can articulate where Ayurveda has strong evidence and where it doesn’t.
- They can steel-man all three integration positions.
- They write a research paper that integrates 3 source types fairly.

Want to go further?

- Wujastyk, D. (2003). *The Roots of Ayurveda*. Penguin.
- Patwardhan, B. et al. (2015). *Integrative Approaches for Health*. Academic Press.
- The AYUSH Ministry website for current policy context.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 3 (Senior) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title	File
1	Ayurveda’s place in IKS	days/day-01-hook.md
2	Caraka primary source	days/day-02-caraka.md
3	Tridosha in depth	days/day-03-tridosha.md
4	Modern evidence	days/day-04-modern-evidence.md
5	Mid + paper topic	days/day-05-mid-module.md
6	BG 6.17 + lifestyle	days/day-06-bg-lifestyle.md

Day	Title	File
7	Integration debate	days/day-07-integration-debate.md
8	Project Session 1	days/day-08-project-session-1.md
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md
10	Final + paper	days/day-10-final-assessment.md

Pacing

- Day 2 (Caraka reading) needs quiet time.
- Day 4 (modern evidence) requires students to engage RCT abstracts — non-trivial.
- Day 7 debate is loaded; honour the discomfort.

What students leave with

- Ayurveda mapped within IKS at scholarly depth.
- Primary source reading skill (Caraka in IAST).
- A defensible position on Ayurveda-in-modern-healthcare.
- One research paper integrating classical + empirical + historical sources.

Homework

Homework — Module 3 (Senior)

Day	Task	Time
1 → 2	Read Wujastyk (2003) intro.	30 min
2 → 3	Re-read Caraka 1.42 verses; note 2 questions.	20 min
3 → 4	Look up Prasher et al. (2008) abstract. Read carefully.	30 min
4 → 5	Submit paper plan: thesis + 3 sources.	30 min
5 → 6	Read Panda (2018) excerpt on circadian.	30 min
6 → 7	Choose debate position; prepare 3-min argument.	45 min
7 → 8	Draft 1 page of paper.	60 min

Day	Task	Time
8 → 9	Continue drafting (2+ pages).	60 min
9 → 10	Finalise, proofread, format.	60 min